

DecisionIQ Master Handbook

CHAPTER 1: The Monday Morning Crisis & The Case for Decision Intelligence

1.1 Monday Morning, 8:00 AM: The Blind Flight

It is Monday morning, 8:00 AM. Arthur Pendelton, the CEO of TechNova Global—a mid-market enterprise supplying cloud infrastructure and hardware servers—sits at his mahogany desk. He opens his executive dashboard, expecting to see the steady upward climb of Q2 revenue. Instead, he is met with a flashing crimson indicator: **Net Sales Revenue has declined by 8.5% over the past six weeks.**

Arthur's heart sinks. He immediately calls an emergency conference with his department directors:

- **The VP of Sales** is defensive: *"Our pipeline is healthy, and the sales team is closing deals. If revenue is down, it's not because we aren't selling."*
- **The VP of Finance** points to a 20% spike in refunds.
- **The VP of Customer Success** warns of a ticket storm: CSAT has plummeted to 1.8 out of 5.0, and clients are threatening subscription cancellations.
- **The Director of Logistics** explains that the West Coast Hub is understaffed and Apex Technology (supplier) is weeks behind schedule.

The meeting dissolves into arguments. Sales is looking at Salesforce; Finance is looking at NetSuite; Logistics is tracking shipping portals; Customer Success is in Zendesk. Arthur realizes TechNova is in **blind flight**. The data exists, but it is siloed. No one can trace how a delay at a supplier's warehouse in Asia cascades into a refund request in California and a customer churn risk in New York.

Arthur doesn't need another dashboard; he needs a central intelligence layer. He needs **DecisionIQ**.

1.2 The Business Need

Traditional Business Intelligence focuses on presenting historical facts. However, in a crisis, a business needs **Decision Intelligence**—a structured methodology that links data points across department silos, diagnoses why performance changed, and recommends specific, high-value business decisions.

1.3 Interview Tips

[!TIP] Q: What is DecisionIQ, and what problem does it solve?

Model Answer: DecisionIQ is an Enterprise Decision Intelligence Platform. It connects Sales, Finance, Logistics, and Customer Success data into a unified schema. It uses advanced SQL, machine learning, and an automated Insight Engine to explain why metrics changed and prescribe financial decisions to the C-suite.

1.4 Chapter Summary

This chapter introduced the central operational problem: organizations operate in data silos, leaving executives unable to diagnose why business metrics decline. DecisionIQ solves this by correlating metrics to deliver actionable decisions.